

The prophetic books

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The prophetic books

- They are called prophetic books because they are believed to be authored by prophets.
- They are believed to be written between 750 BC and 450 BC.
- There are 5 major prophets, Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniels, and there are 12 minor books, Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi.

Major Prophetic Books

- They are as follows:
 1. Isaiah
 2. Jeremiah
 3. Lamentations
 4. Ezekiel
 5. Daniel
- They are called major prophetic books because they are the longest books of the prophetic books.

Isaiah

Introduction

- Scholars believe the books was authored by Isaiah and other anonymous writers. However, it is united in its message of judgement and restoration of Israel.
- It has been very influential in the Christian religion, with some having considered it the 5th gospel. Its influence has gone beyond christianity, and influenced the western culture and literature.

Structure

1. Isaiah is contemporarily divided into 2 parts:
 - Chapters 1-33: Warning of Judgement and restoration of Jerusalem, Judah and the nations.
 - Chapters 34 - 66: Assumes Judgement and talks about restoration.
2. It has been believed in the past to be divided into 3 parts:
 - Chapters 1–39: Proto-Isaiah, containing the words of the original Isaiah.
 - Chapters 40–55: Deutero-Isaiah, the work of an anonymous Exilic author.
 - Chapters 56–66: Trito-Isaiah, an anthology of about twelve passages.
- In this overview, we work with the 1st structure.

Overview

1st Isaiah: Chapters 1 to 33.

- Isaiah begins by setting out the themes of judgement and restoration, inviting Jerusalem to join in God's plan of making it the ruler of the world.
- Chapters 5 - 12 talk about the importance of Assyrian judgement on Israel, and the rule of a Davidic king afterwards
- Chapters 13 - 27 talk about the preparation of the nations for God's rule(making Jerusalem the leader of the world)
- Chapters 28 - 33 announce the arrival of the Messiah after the punishment and destruction of Israel's oppressors.

Overview

2nd Isaiah: Chapters 34 to 54.

The oppressor, Babylon is about to fall

- Chapters 34 - 35 talk about the return of the redeemed exiles to Jerusalem by God.
- Chapters 36 - 39 talk about king Hezekiah, and his exemplifying faithfulness in God during the Assyrian Siege.
- Chapters 40 - 54 talk about the restoration of Zion as Cyrus the Great is chosen as the Messiah by God and the builder of the Temple. He is the “suffering servant who will become the Messiah” as said in later chapters.

Overview

2nd Isaiah: Chapters 55 to 66.

- Chapters 55 - 66 are an exhortation to Israel to keep the covenant.
- God has fulfilled his promise to David given in 2 Samuel 7: 1-17.
- Isaiah ends by prescribing righteousness as the last step for God's plan to come to pass, including the pilgrimage of the nations to Zion.

Themes

1. **Holiness, Righteousness and God's plan:** Isaiah talks about how God's plan for the world begins with Israel, and the line of David as his representative. It also talks of God, "The Holy One of Israel," having Justice and Righteousness as his essence, and Israel has offended God with Evil and unrighteousness. Isaiah speaks against the corrupt, and roots righteousness in God's holiness.

Themes

1. **Monotheism:** Isaiah 44-66 contains the 1st clear statement of monotheism. “I am the first and last: beside me, there is no other God.” in Isaiah 44: 9 - 20, the carpenter is mocked for worshiping a statue that has been carved with his hands using tools, despite God having proven his superiority over other gods. In the second half of Isaiah(Second Isaiah) The Lord becomes the sole God in the world.

Themes

3. **New Exodus:** Isaiah speaks greatly about the return of the exiled(New Exodus) to Jerusalem from Babylon. This is repeatedly linked to Israel's exodus from Egypt.

Lessons

1. **Judgement and Repentance:** Isaiah repeatedly warns Judah about judgement as a consequence of their idolatry, social injustice and failure to uphold God's covenant. However, he also calls them to repentance. This is a reminder that God is just and merciful, he always calls us to repentance, and he is always trying to connect with us.

Lessons

2. **The promise of the Messiah:** Isaiah speaks largely of a messiah who will bring salvation to God's people. This is a reminder of the work Jesus did and the hope we have because of that. Israelites were living in a period of oppression and suffering when they received their Messiah.

Lessons

3. **God is Sovereign and Holy:** Isaiah emphasizes God's absolute sovereignty, portraying him as the Holy One who rules over earth. This reminds us of God's power and calls us to live in humility, respect and recognition of his authority and power.

Sources

[Book of Isaiah - Wikipedia](#)

[Prophetic books - Wikipedia](#)

[Understanding the Book of Isaiah: Key Themes and Messages – Brisbane Mahimit Mandali](#)

Jeremiah

Introduction

- Scholars believe the books was authored by Jeremiah, and it was later edited by his followers.

Structure

Jeremiah can be roughly divided into 6 parts:

- Chapters 1–25 (The earliest and main core of Jeremiah's message).
- Chapters 26–29 (Biographic material and interaction with other prophets).
- Chapters 30–33 (God's promise of restoration including Jeremiah's "new covenant" which is interpreted differently in Judaism than it is in Christianity).
- Chapters 34–45 (Mostly interaction with Zedekiah and the fall of Jerusalem).
- Chapters 46–51 (Divine punishment to the nations surrounding Israel).
- Chapter 52 (Appendix that retells 2 Kings)

Overview

Jeremiah: Chapters 1 to 25.

- Chapters 1 - 24 talk about God calling Jeremiah to become a prophet and giving him 2 tasks: to warn Judah about God's judgement and to give them hope for the future. In Chapter 7 Israelites come to worship God in the temple, and right outside before they enter the temple, they worship idols, and perform the heinous act of child sacrifice. On this day, Jeremiah announces to them that God will Bring them judgement and exile through a Babylonian king.
- In Chapter 25 God asks Jeremiah to inform the Israelite that King Nebuchadnezzar's army was coming to conquer them and send them into a 70 year exile .

Overview

Jeremiah: Chapters 26 to 45.

- Chapters 26 - 45 talk about the siege on Jerusalem. Despite several warnings, Israelites still remain unrighteous and the babylonians finally conquer them. Jeremiah is kidnapped and taken to Egypt. Later on, Jeremiah brings hope, talking about Moses' prophecy, and reminding them that God would not abandon his people, he will free them and use the line of david to save the world.

Overview

Jeremiah: Chapters 47 to 52.

- Chapters 47 - 52 talk about the judgement God does on Babylon and all other nations. After God uses Babylon to judge the other nation around Israel, he judges them because they are too violent and commit idolatry. The book ends with a story from 2 Kings, which shows how Jeremiah's warning of Judgement is fulfilled.

Themes

1. **Covenant:** Much of Jeremiah is about the covenant God made with the Israelites. God promised he would protect the people if they worship exclusively him. As a result of not worshiping God, comparing this act to prostitution, Israel is not protected during the siege on Jerusalem.

Themes

2. **God uses human agents:** God uses Jeremiah to deliver his message and other prophets. God also uses King Nebuchadnezzar as his servant to deliver judgement on Israel and the other unrighteous nations.

Themes

3. **Judgement as circumcision will of God:** God wills for the Israelites to come back to him. He uses judgement(conquering by Babylon and 70 years exile) to help the Israelites realise their mistakes. He is always ready to welcome those who repent.

Lessons

1. **Judgement and Repentance:** After warning Israel several times about impending judgement, he reminds Israel that God has not abandoned them, and will save them, pointing to Moses' prophecy.

Lessons

2. **The Role of Lament:** Jeremiah is often referred to as the “weeping prophet” because of how deep he laments over the suffering his people have to endure. His lamentations give a model for expressing grief and seeking comfort in God.

Lessons

3. **The need for spiritual leadership:** Jeremiah confront various false prophets misleading people with false assurances of peace. God condemns these prophets for talking lies in his name. This warns us against false teachings, and highlights the importance of righteous spiritual leaders.

Sources

[Book of Jeremiah - Wikipedia](#)

[Summary of the Book of Jeremiah - Bible Survey | GotQuestions.org](#)

[Book of Jeremiah: Guide with Key Information and Resources](#)

[Theological Themes in Jeremiah - Enter the Bible](#)

[What lessons can we learn from the book of Jeremiah?](#)

Lamentations

Introduction

- It is a collection of poetic laments for the destruction of Jerusalem in the 586 BCE.
- It is believed to have been authored by Jeremiah.

Structure

- Lamentations consists of 5 non chronological poems. 2 of its defining features are the alphabetic acrostic and its qinah meter. However, very few English translations capture this.
- The acrostics include chapters 1, 2 and 4, each having 22 chapters(the number of hebrew letter).
- The qinah includes chapters 3 and 5.

Overview

- Chapter 1: The city sits as a suffering and desolate widow is overcome with miseries.
- Chapter 2: These miseries are described in connection to the nation's sins and the acts of God.
- Chapter 3: Speaks of hope for the people of God.
- Chapter 4: Laments the ruin of the city and temple but traces it to the people's sins.
- Chapter 5: It is a prayer that Zion's reproach may be taken away in the repentance and recovery of the people.

Themes

1. **Divine Justice:** The poems convey the notion that the suffering experienced by the people is as a result of their collective sin. However, they also ask for God's mercy during this period of suffering.

Themes

2. **Communal grief:** The poems serve as a formal way for the community to express their sorrow for their situation, and seek comfort and peace.

Themes

1. **Hope and Restoration:** Though very subtly, the poems, during intense moments of sorrow talk about hope and restoration. Despite intense pain, there are little sparkles of hope and restoration.

Lessons

1. **Actions have consequences:** The people left God, broke their covenant, and committed idolatry. This happens after God had warned them that if they don't change from their ways, they will suffer. Consequently, they enter a period of suffering and exile. This informs us that every bad action we take has a consequence. It may be now, it may be in the future. It may be to us, it may be to our children.

Lessons

2. **There is a way back:** We always wrong God, and there is nothing we say that can win us back God's favour. However, God is always happy and ready to open his arms to give us a warm embrace when we decide to go back to him.

Sources

[Book of Lamentations - Wikipedia](#)

[The Book of Lamentations: History, Themes, and Influence - DivineNarratives](#)

[Five Essential Life Lessons from Lamentations - jimthefollower.com](#)

Ezekiel

Introduction

- It is a record of 6 visions of the prophet Ezekiel.
- He had this vision during exile from 593 BC to 571 BC.

Structure

It can be divided into 3 parts:

- Chapters 1 - 24: Prophecies against Judah and Jerusalem.
- Chapters 25 - 32: Prophecies against the foreign nations.
- Chapters 33 - 48: Prophecies of hope and salvation.

Overview

- Chapters 1 - 3: God calls Ezekiel to serve him. Ezekiel receives visions and his message is face sinful nations.
- Chapters 4 - 24: Ezekiel talks of doom to the captives. He compares Israel to adulterous women. He teaches them that God is cleansing Israel.
- Chapters 25 - 32: Ezekiel condemns Judgement upon Ammon, Moab, Edom, Philistia, Tyre Sidon and Egypt for they have Israelites in captivity.
- Chapters 33 to 48: Ezekiel delivers a message of hope and restoration. Not only for Israel, but also for the future Messiah(Jesus) coming.

Themes

1. **God is powerful:** The Book of Ezekiel lets the power of God to be seen and felt. It prioritizes God's voice over the prophetic voice. Usually, God asks the prophet to say an oracle or do something. However, Ezekiel does not depict him carrying out an act. God's command is enough.

Themes

2. **The holy character of God:** The holiness of the Lord is a constant theme of this book. It appears in visual form in the awesome throne vision(Ezekiel 1: 4 -28). Divine holiness demands that evildoers be punished. Because of divine holiness and righteousness, God punishes the people. Yet, he does not destroy them completely.

Themes

3. **Rethinking salvation history:** During exile, Israelites are faced with doubt and unbelief: is their God real or just a local deity of little importance? Ezekiel's enduring "yes" to continued faith in God occurs along with a willingness to rethink key issues in the relationship Israelites have with God, including the Covenant.

Lessons

1. **God equips us for the call:** Even in the most difficult circumstances, God equips us to handle the mission he's set us on. Ezekiel was called to a hopeless mission, and was given a stubborn heart so he could be perseverant and unrelenting to the truth. When we are called, we are given everything we need to complete the call.

Lessons

2. **God's word is consistent:** Ezekiel was delivering the same message Jeremiah was given. However, he was delivering this message to the exiled. There is consistency in the message Ezekiel and Jeremiah delivered to God's people. God is consistent in what he says, and he will never contradict himself.

Lessons

3. **God's perspective on punishment of the wicked:** It is God's will the people repent and come back to him. However, God's integrity and righteousness are displayed when the unrepentant are punished.

Sources

[Book of Ezekiel - Wikipedia](#)

[Ezekiel Summary](#)

[Theological Themes in Ezekiel - Enter the Bible](#)

[Ezekiel Teaches Seven Surprising Life Lessons - jimthefollower.com](#)

Daniel

Introduction

- It is a an account of the activities and visions of Daniel.
- He had this vision during exile in 560-536 BC.

Structure

It can be divided into 2 parts:

- Chapters 1 - 6: Tales.
- Chapters 7 - 12: Vision.

Overview

Tales: Chapters 1 to 6.

Daniel writes about his life in captivity: He was selected to work for king Nebuchadnezzar. He and his friends make several tough decisions that helped them display their integrity to stand for Godliness instead of culture. They rejected the king's food, prayed when it was illegal and refused to do idolatry, and were later thrown in a hot and burning furnace. Daniel interpreted Nebuchadnezzar's dreams twice, and was promoted to chief of all the wise men in Babylon. However great his deeds were always claimed he did it through God and gave glory to God.

Overview

Visions: Chapters 7 to 12.

It contains the vision God gives Daniel and the happenings in his prophetic life. It includes the earthly kingdoms that he lived in. They also mention the coming messiah and the apocalyptic events to come.

Themes

1. **Faithfulness amid Trials:** A prominent Theme in the book of Daniel is the steadfast endurance of believers under persecution. Daniel and his friends stand firm in their commitment, even when threatened to be executed in a fire furnace, or the lion's den. Each of these points to God's strength and protection, encouraging others to become and stay righteous.

Themes

2. **The power of Prayer:** Prayer was very important in Daniel's life. Whether interpreting dreams or pleading for Israel's restoration. Daniel gives a model for the seeking of divine guidance through prayer and fasting.

Themes

3. **Prophecy and apocalyptic revelation:** Daniel's prophetic sections is one of the most detailed visions in the Holy Bible, foretelling events from the rise and fall of near Eastern empires to future global upheavals. Daniel includes a vivid and long description of successive kingdoms often interpreted as Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece and Rome followed by an everlasting kingdom

Lessons

1. **We have to stand firm and remain trustfull during trials:** In the first chapter, Daniel and his friends refuse the royal rations that threaten their faith. They make other tough choices that lead them to the fiery furnace and the lion's den. However, they stand firm in their faith and are protected by God's power

Lessons

2. **The power of persistent prayer:** Even under threat, Daniel maintained his prayer routine. The book of Daniel tells us he got down on his knees three times a day and prayed and gave thanks to God. Prayer is not a ritual, it is the life force of genuine faithfulness.

Lessons

3. **Humility precedes honor:** Nebuchadnezzar learned this lesson the hard way, experiencing the humbling of his pride. Later he acknowledges the power of God saying “Now I Nebuchadnezzar praise, exalt and honor the King of heaven”. Pride has a way of bringing people low; humility, on the other hand paves the way for wholeness and blessing.

Sources

[Daniel Summary](#)

[Book of Daniel - Wikipedia](#)

[What are the main themes in the Book of Daniel?](#)

[Top 10 Lessons from the Book of Daniel](#)

Minor Prophetic Books

- They are as follows: Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi.
- They are called minor prophetic books because they are short, with the longest having 14 chapters

Introduction to Hosea, Joel, and Amos

- These three books are part of the **Minor Prophets** in the Old Testament. The term “Minor” does not mean they are less important but refers to their shorter length compared to the Major Prophets (like Isaiah and Jeremiah).
- Each of these prophets had a unique message for God’s people, addressing their sins, warning them of judgment, and calling them to repentance

1.The book of Hosea

- Introduction

- Hosea was a prophet in the Northern Kingdom of Israel during the 8th century BC, under the reign of Jeroboam II.
- His book is unique because God commanded him to marry **Gomer**, an unfaithful woman, symbolizing Israel's spiritual adultery.
- Hosea's message focuses on **God's unfailing love** despite Israel's **sin and unfaithfulness**.

Main Themes

- **God's Love and Mercy** – Despite Israel's sins, God continues to call them back (Hosea 11:8-9).
- **Spiritual Adultery** – Israel was unfaithful by worshiping idols (Hosea 2:2-5).
- **Judgment and Restoration** – Israel's sin brings judgment, but God promises restoration (Hosea 14:4-7).

LESSONS TO LEARN

- God's love is unconditional, even when we fail Him (Hosea 3:1).
- Sin has consequences, but God always provides a way for restoration (Hosea 6:1-3).
- True repentance leads to renewal (Hosea 14:1-2).

2. The Book of Joel

- Introduction

- Joel was a prophet in Judah, possibly during the 9th or 6th century BC.
- His prophecy focuses on a **locust plague** that symbolizes God's judgment.
- He also speaks about the **Day of the Lord**, a time of judgment and future blessing.

Main Themes

- **The Day of the Lord** – A time of judgment for sin and deliverance for the faithful (Joel 2:1-2).
- **Repentance and Restoration** – God calls His people to return to Him (Joel 2:12-13).
- **Outpouring of the Holy Spirit** – A prophecy fulfilled in Acts 2 (Joel 2:28-29)

LESSONS TO LEARN

- God allows difficulties to bring us to repentance (Joel 1:14).
- When we return to God, He restores and blesses us (Joel 2:25-26).
- The Holy Spirit is available to all who seek God (Joel 2:28-29)

3. The Book of Amos

- Introduction

- Amos was a shepherd from **Tekoa** in Judah, but he prophesied to the **Northern Kingdom of Israel** (about 760 BC).
- His message was against **social injustice** and **false religion** in Israel.
- He warned that **God's judgment was coming** if Israel did not repent.

Main Themes

- **God's Justice** – God demands righteousness and justice (Amos 5:24).
- **Judgment for Oppression** – Israel was guilty of exploiting the poor (Amos 2:6-7).
- **True Worship** – God rejects empty religious rituals without true devotion (Amos 5:21-23)

LESSONS TO LEARN

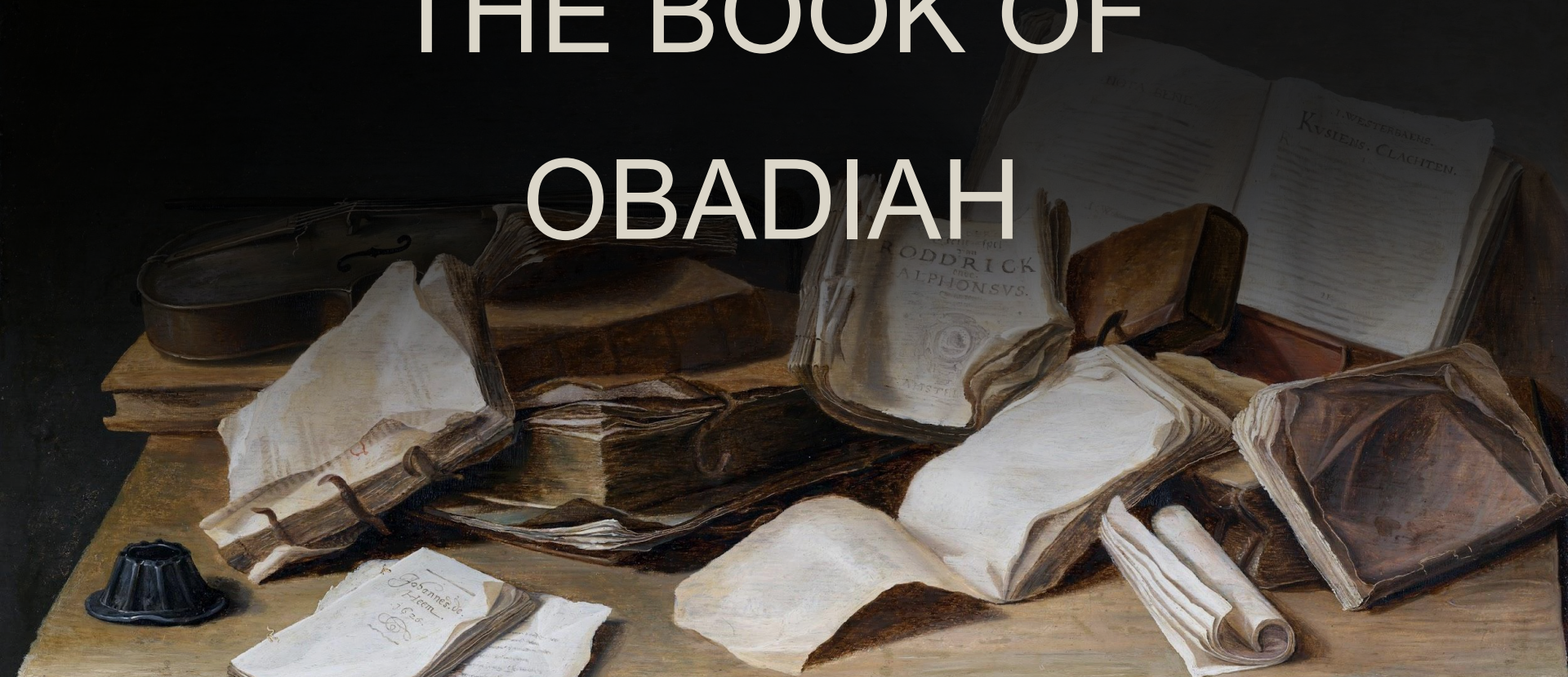
- God expects justice and righteousness in society (Amos 5:14-15).
- Religious activities without a right heart mean nothing to God (Amos 5:21-24).
- Pride and ignoring God's warnings lead to destruction (Amos 6:1-7)

Final Lessons to Take Away

- God desires a relationship, not just religious rituals.
- True repentance leads to restoration and blessings.
- Justice and righteousness matter deeply to God.
- God is both merciful and just—He calls us to turn to Him before judgment comes.

These three books complement each other, showing different aspects of God's character—His love (Hosea), His call to repentance (Joel), and His demand for justice (Amos)

THE BOOK OF OBADIAH



Overview

The book of Obadiah is the shortest in the Old Testament, containing a prophecy against Edom for its pride and betrayal of Israel. It declares God's judgment on Edom, predicting its downfall. The book also promises Israel's restoration and victory. Ultimately, it emphasizes God's justice and the coming Day of the Lord.

Moral Lessons

01

Pride Leads to Destruction : Edom's downfall came from arrogance and overconfidence, showing that humility is essential.

02

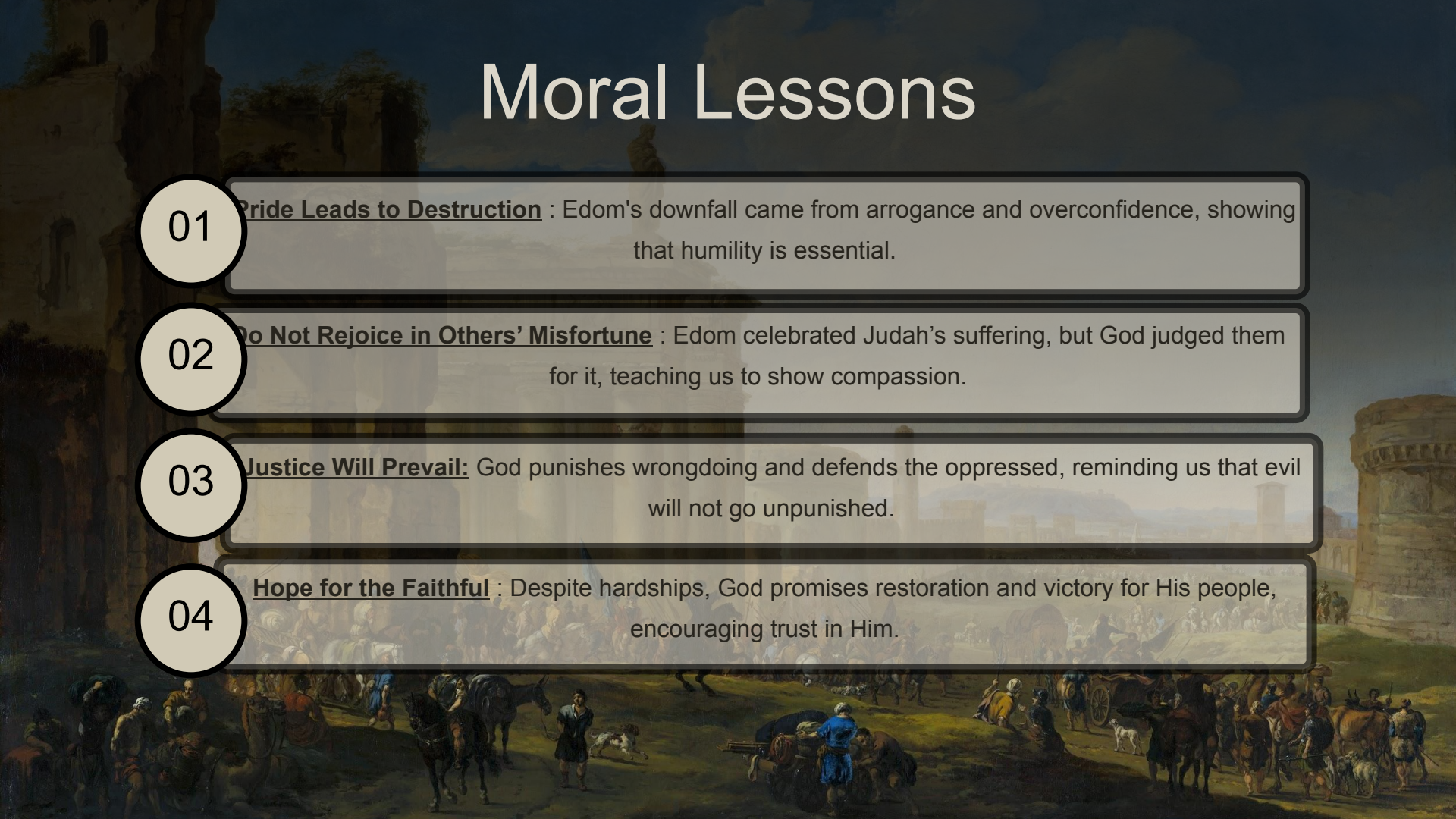
Do Not Rejoice in Others' Misfortune : Edom celebrated Judah's suffering, but God judged them for it, teaching us to show compassion.

03

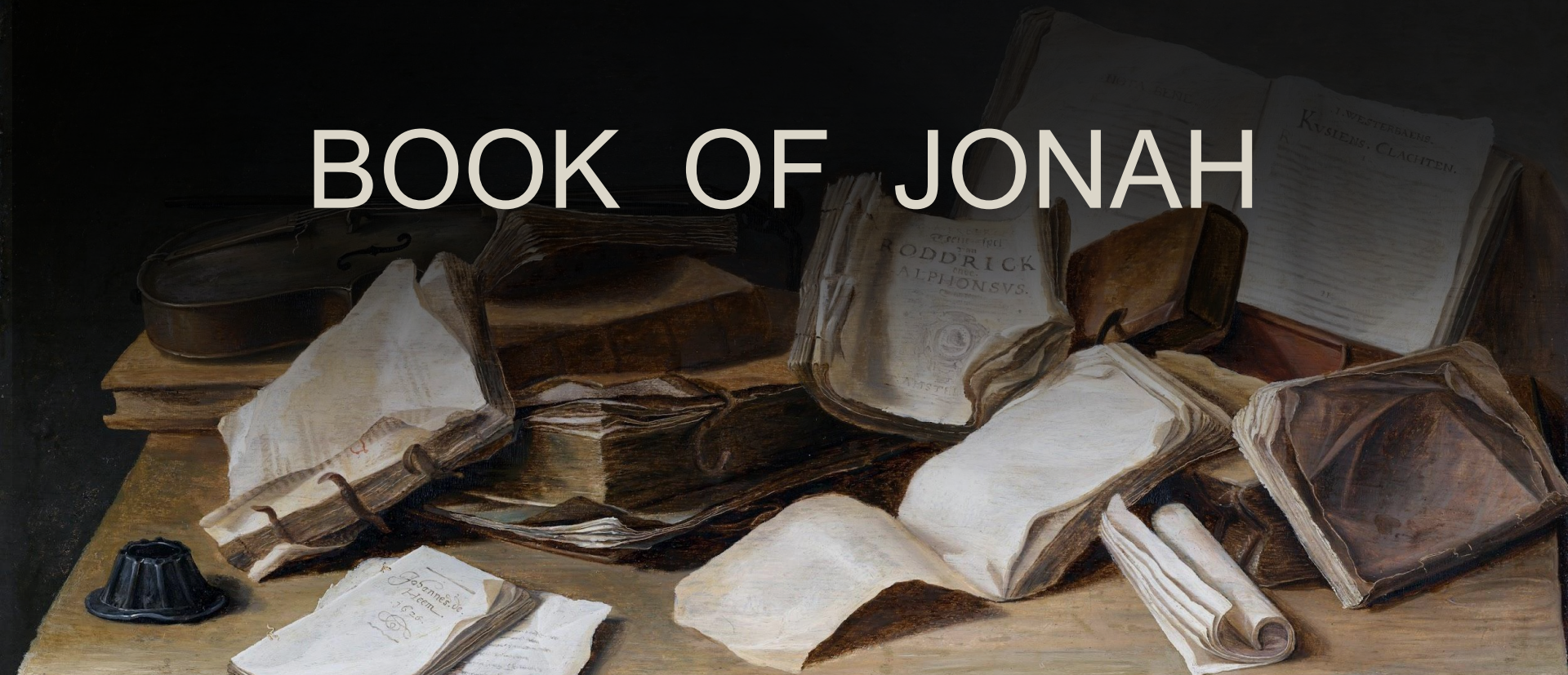
Justice Will Prevail: God punishes wrongdoing and defends the oppressed, reminding us that evil will not go unpunished.

04

Hope for the Faithful : Despite hardships, God promises restoration and victory for His people, encouraging trust in Him.



BOOK OF JONAH



Overview

The Book of Jonah is a prophetic book in the Old Testament that tells the story of Jonah, a reluctant prophet sent by God to preach repentance to Nineveh. Instead of obeying, Jonah tries to flee, but

God intervenes through a storm and a great fish. The book highlights God's mercy, human disobedience, and divine justice.

Historical Background

- **Time Period:** Around 8th century BCE (during the reign of Jeroboam II, 786–746 BCE)
- **Nineveh:** Capital of Assyria, known for its cruelty and brutality
- **Assyrian Threat:** Assyria was a powerful enemy of Israel, making Jonah reluctant to preach there
- **Authorship:** Traditionally attributed to Jonah, though debated by scholars

Major Themes in Jonah

- ◆ **God's Mercy** – God forgives even the worst sinners if they repent.
- ◆ **Human Rebellion vs. Obedience:** Jonah initially runs from his calling but later fulfills it.
- ◆ **Divine Justice** – God holds all nations accountable, including Israel's enemies.
- ◆ **Universal Salvation** – God's love extends beyond Israel to all people, including Nineveh.
- ◆ **God's Sovereignty** – Nature, animals, and people are all under God's control



Moral Lessons

01

You Can't Escape God's Plan – Running from responsibility leads to consequences.

02

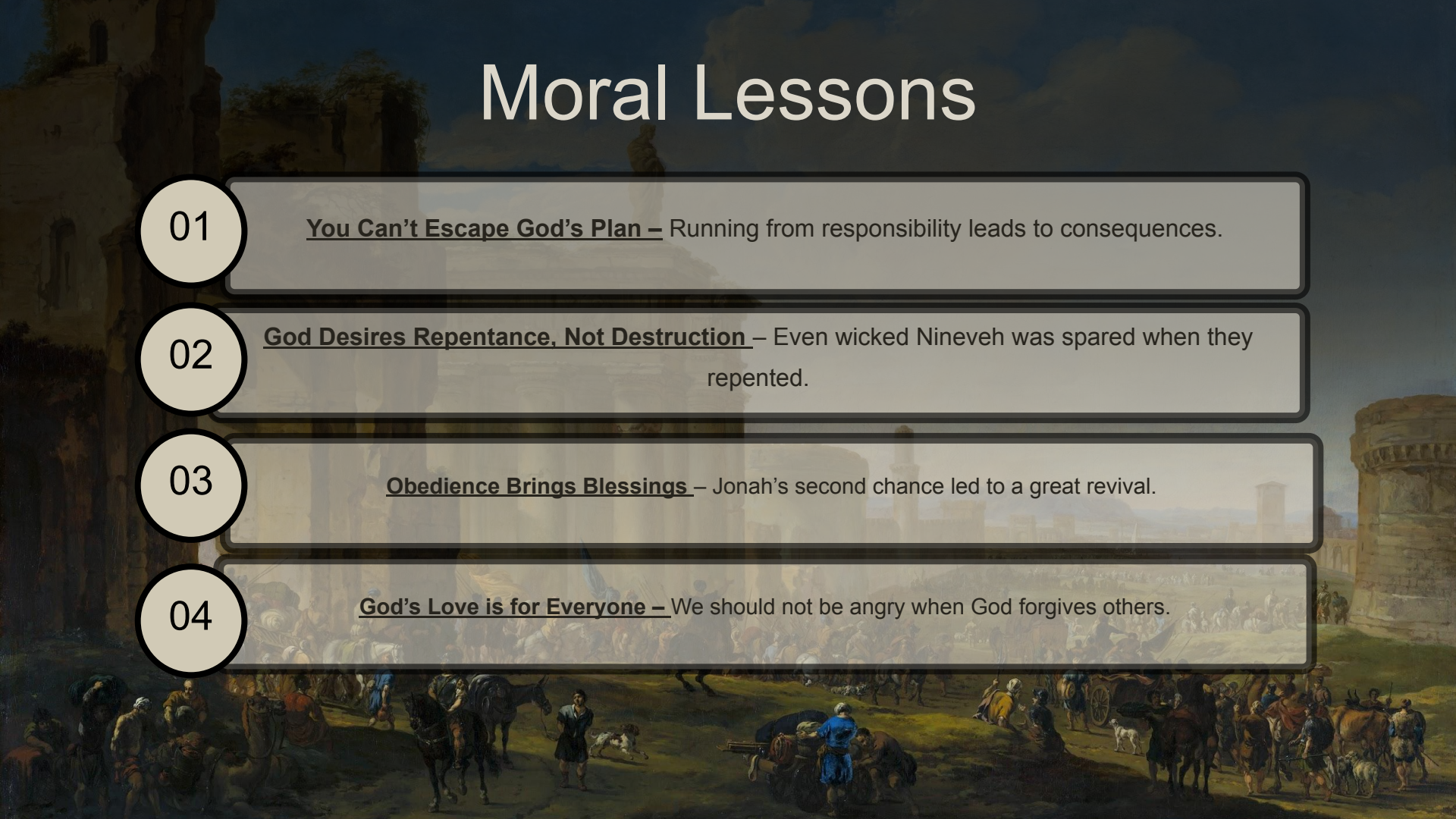
God Desires Repentance, Not Destruction – Even wicked Nineveh was spared when they repented.

03

Obedience Brings Blessings – Jonah's second chance led to a great revival.

04

God's Love is for Everyone – We should not be angry when God forgives others.



THE BOOK OF MICAHA



Overview

The Book of Micah is a prophetic book in the Old Testament, written by the prophet Micah. It contains warnings of judgment against Israel and Judah due to their sins, but also promises of restoration and the coming Messiah. Micah condemns corruption, oppression, and idolatry while calling people to justice, humility, and faithfulness to God

Historical Background

- **Time Period:** Around 735–700 BCE (during the reigns of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah in Judah)
- **Micah's Hometown:** Moresheth (a small town in Judah)
- **Political Context:**
 - Assyria was rising in power and threatening both Israel and
 - Samaria (Israel's capital) would soon be destroyed (722 BCE).
 - Judah was corrupt, with leaders exploiting the poor.

Major Themes in Jonah

- ♦ **Divine Justice** – God will punish sin but also offer mercy to the repentant.
- ♦ **Social Justice** – Micah condemns oppression, corruption, and greed, emphasizing care for the poor.
- ♦ **Messianic Prophecy** – The prophecy of Jesus' birth in Bethlehem (Micah 5:2) foretells the coming of the Savior.
- ♦ **True Worship & Righteous Living** – God desires justice, mercy, and humility, not just religious rituals.
- ♦ **Judgment & Restoration** – While Israel faces punishment, God's promises of future hope remain.



Moral Lessons

01

God Hates Injustice – Oppressing the weak and corrupt leadership will lead to divine judgment.

02

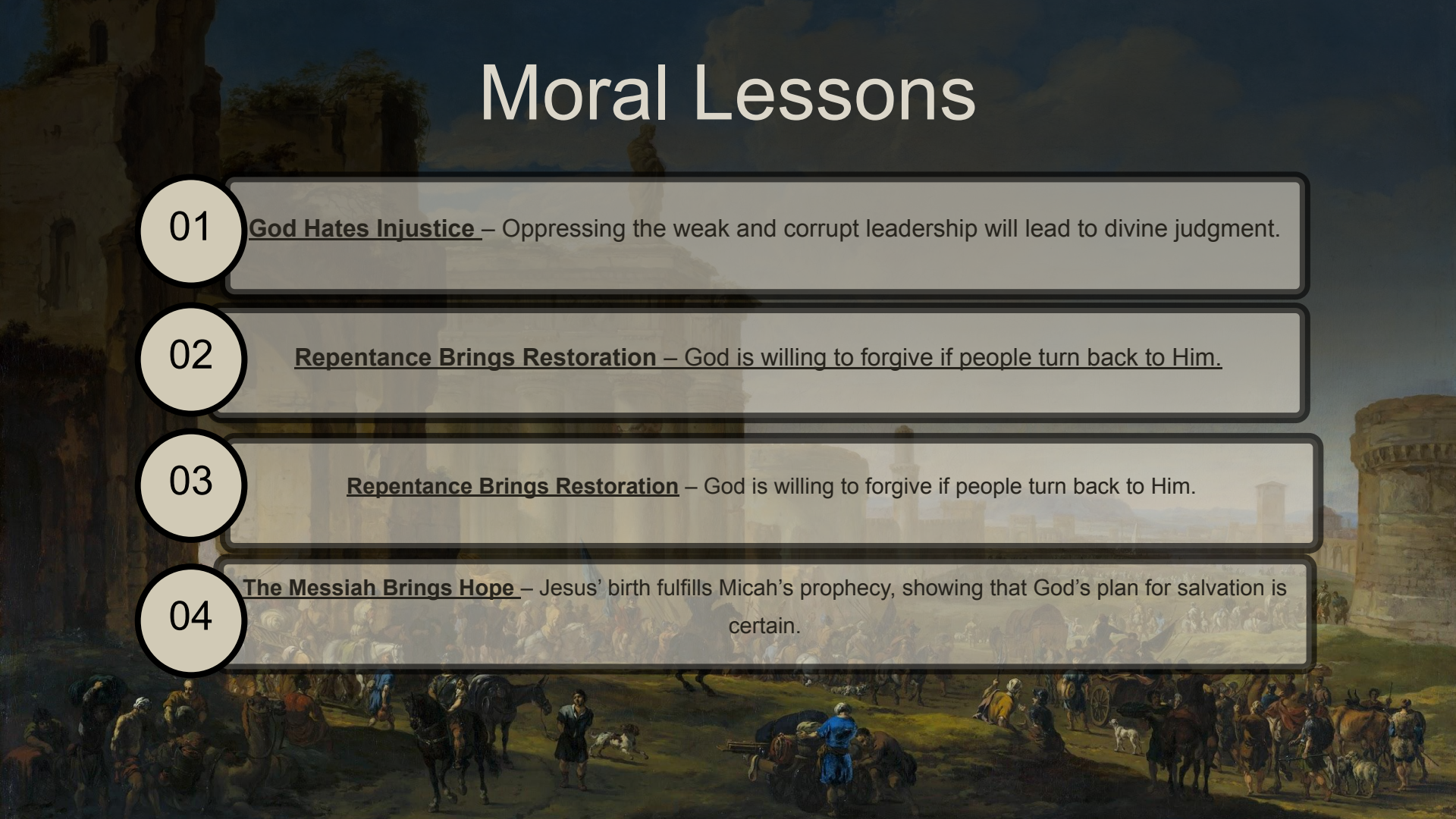
Repentance Brings Restoration – God is willing to forgive if people turn back to Him.

03

Repentance Brings Restoration – God is willing to forgive if people turn back to Him.

04

The Messiah Brings Hope – Jesus' birth fulfills Micah's prophecy, showing that God's plan for salvation is certain.



Introduction to Bible study

- Presentation of the book of Habakkuk, Haggai and Malachi.

Written: Hashimwimana Bruno

1. Introduction

- **Author:** The prophet Habakkuk
- **Date Written:** Likely Between 612 – 589 Bc before the Babylonian invasion of Judah
- **Historical context:** The book was written during a time of great injustice and moral decline in Judah. The rising power of Babylon (Chaldeans) threatened nation.

2. Main themes

- **Questioning God's justice:** Habakkuk struggles with why God allows wickedness to prevail.
- **God's Sovereignty:** God assures that he is in control and will bring justice in his time
- **Faith in God:** The Righteous will live by Faith (Habakkuk 2:4), a key verse referenced in the New testament (Romans 1:17, Galatians 3:11, Hebrews 10:38).

3. Structure of the book

❑ CHAPTER 1: Habakkuk's Complaint and God's Answer

- The prophet Questions why God Tolerates Evil.
- God responds that he will use Babylon to punish Judah

❑ CHAPTER 2: God's Justice and Judgment

- God reveals Five "Woes" against the wicked (pride, greed, violence, corruption and idolatry).
- The Key Verse: "the just shall live by his faith"(Habakkuk 2:4).

❑ CHAPTER 3: Habakkuk's Prayer and praise

- A poetic prayer expressing trust in God.
- Ends with A declaration of faith: "Yet I will rejoice in the Lord..."(Habakkuk 3:17-19)

4. Key lesson from Habakkuk

- It's okay to question God, but we must trust his wisdom
- God may use unexpected means (even wicked nations) to fulfil his plans
- True Faith remains strong even in difficult times

CONCLUSION:

Habakkuk teaches us that, despite the challenges and injustices in the world, God's justice will prevail, and the righteous must live by faith, his closing words encourage believers to trust in God's salvation, no matter the circumstances.

The book of Haggai and Malachi

● Introduction:

- Haggai and Malachi are two of the minor prophets in the old testament.
- Both Books focus on spiritual renewal and faithfulness to God, written after the Israelites returned from exile.

2. The book of Haggai (520 BC)

- ◆ **Theme:** Rebuilding God's House & Prioritizing Him
- ◆ The Israelites returned from exile but neglected the temple of God, Focusing on their own homes.
 - **Key message:** "Give careful thought to your ways"(Haggai 1:5,7).
 - **Call to action:**
 - God challenges them to rebuild his temple.
 - When They obey, God blesses them.
 - **Future Promise:** The new temple will be greater than the old, pointing to the messiah (Jesus Christ)

3. The book of Malachi (430 BC)

- ❖ **Theme:** Spiritual Renewal & God's Faithfulness
- ❖ Written 100 year after Haggai, Malachi confronts Israel's spiritual decline.
 - **Key Issues:**
 - ✓ Corrupt Priests and careless worship
 - ✓ People rob God by withholding tithes and offering
 - **God's Call:**
 - ❑ "Return to me, and I will return to you" (Malachi 3:7)
 - ❑ A prophecy of John the Baptist as the forerunner of Christ (Malachi 3:1)
 - **Final Warning & Hope:**
 - Judgment for the wicked
 - Promise of The messiah – The "sun of Righteousness" will come (Malachi 4:2)

4. Key lesson from Haggai & Malachi and their conclusion

- Put God First – Haggai : Rebuild The temple, Malachi: Offer true worship.
- Obedience Brings Blessings _ God rewards faithfulness.
- Hope in the messiah _ Both the books point to Jesus as the ultimate fulfilment of God's Promises.

◆ By CONCLUSION:

- Haggai and Malachi teach us that God desires our Full commitment. He call his people to Faithfulness, obedience, and hope in Christ.
- Thanks.

Nahum

Theme:

The destruction of Nineveh (capital of Assyria) and God's judgment on evil nations

Key Points:

1. **God's Justice & Wrath** – Nahum proclaims that God will bring judgment upon Nineveh for its cruelty, arrogance, and oppression.
2. **Fall of Nineveh** – Unlike Jonah (who saw Nineveh repent), Nahum foretells its complete destruction.
3. **God's Faithfulness** – While God punishes the wicked, He protects those who trust in Him.

Key Verse:

"The Lord is good, a refuge in times of trouble. He cares for those who trust in him" (Nahum 1:7)

Zephaniah

Theme:

The "Day of the Lord" – judgment for the wicked and hope for the faithful.

Key Points:

1. **Judgment on Judah & Nations – Zephaniah warns that God will punish Judah for idolatry and wickedness.**
2. **The Day of the Lord – A coming time of destruction and renewal.**
3. **Restoration & Hope – God promises to restore a faithful remnant and bless them.**

Key Verse:

"The Lord your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you" (Zephaniah 3:17)

Zechariah

Summary:

Zechariah prophesies after the Babylonian exile, encouraging the Jews to rebuild the temple and restore their faith in God. The book contains visions about God's plan, the coming Messiah, and the future restoration of Israel. It emphasizes God's presence, protection, and ultimate victory.

Moral Lessons:

- 1. God's plans will always be fulfilled – Even in hardship, His promises remain.**
- 2. Spiritual renewal is as important as physical rebuilding – The Jews were not just rebuilding a temple, but also their faith.**
- 3. The Messiah will bring ultimate salvation – Zechariah prophesies about Jesus as the King of Peace.**

God Bless !